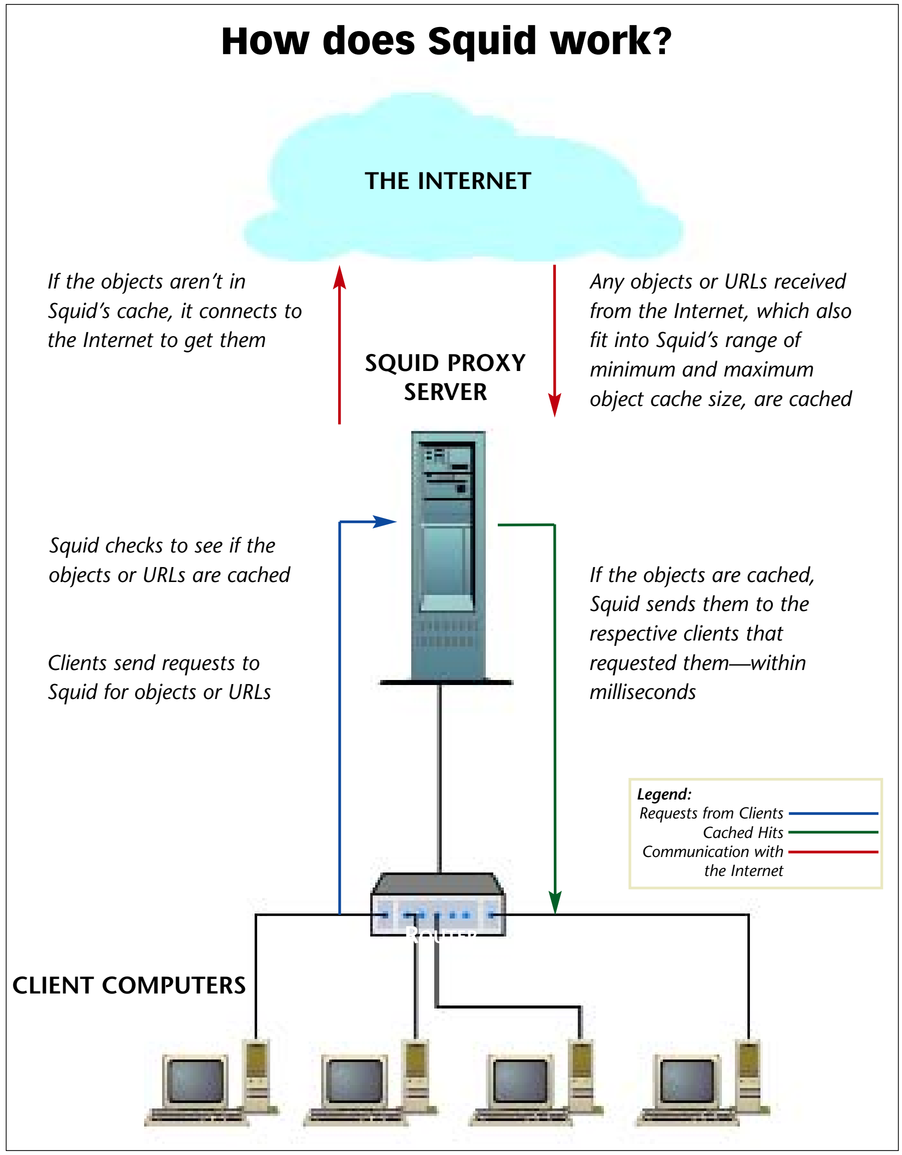



you're looking for a little advanced tweaking, you can set it up to bandwidth-throttle clients, either individually or by groups.

## Saves bandwidth? How?

Once configured, Squid saves caches of images and even entire pages. Hence, if you and your colleagues have Yahoo! e-mail accounts, a normal router just sends your requests to the Internet; Squid, on the other hand, checks if it has visited the same page recently. If your colleague just visited a site and you go to the same URL soon after, instead of loading the page afresh, Squid loads it straight from its cache. This saves bandwidth, and also translates to a better user experience, as pages load faster.

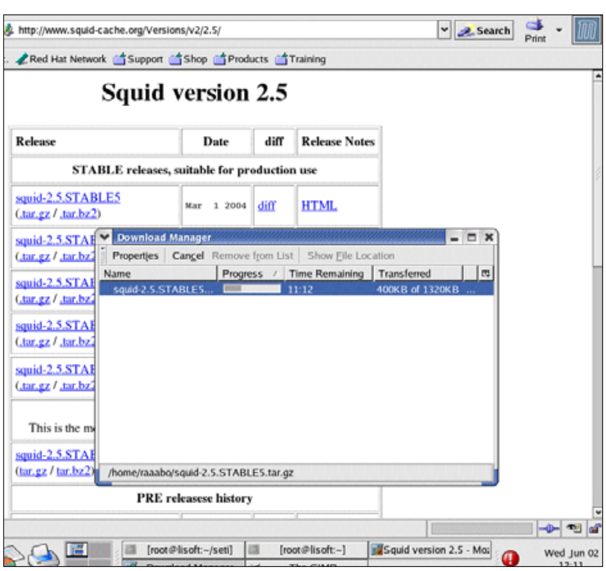
## How do I know if I need it?

If you live in India, and have a 'broadband' connection that you want shared over multiple computers, trust us, you need it!

OK, seriously, if you're looking for a low cost, secure solution to share an Internet connection over an existing LAN, Squid is the sanest solution. It's free and can be run off a battered old Linux box with a decent hard drive, and as much RAM as you can install—the minimum being 128 MB.

## So, what do I need?

Just log onto ***www.squid-cache.org*** and download the latest stable release, by clicking on the link under 'Versions'. Choose the '.tar.gz' file to download. You can load and run Squid on Linux, FreeBSD, NetBSD, OpenBSD, etc, and also on Mac OS/X, OS/2, SunOS/Solaris and Windows via Cygwin.




*Just log on to* ***www.squid-cache.org*** *and download the latest stable version of Squid*

Hardware requirements depend on the level of caching you expect the proxy to do, and the amount of traffic it receives. So, to set up a proxy for, say, two to five computers at home using a dial-up Internet connection, all you need is a low-end machine with about 128 MB of RAM and 1 or 2 GB of space for caching. You also need a modem or Ethernet card to connect to the Internet and another Ethernet card to connect to your local LAN.

An office proxy that is to handle over 50 computers does need a good hardware configuration. A bare minimum will be a 1 GHz processor, 512 MB of RAM, and 10 to 20 GB of free hard disk space. Remember, Squid's performance isn't really CPU-intensive, but does use a lot of RAM and hard disk space, so if you can get 2 GB of RAM and 15,000-rpm hard drives, there's nothing like it—the hard drive is always a bottleneck.

## OK, now what?

Now you need to install Squid. Use the ***'tar'*** command to unzip the downloaded file. For example, if the file you downloaded is called 'squid-2.5.STABLE5.tar.gz', use ***'tar xvzf***